



SYMPATHY

We extend our sympathy to the family and friends of:
EILEEN McLAUGHLIN, Derry who has died recently.

ANNIVERSARIES:

Mary (Molly) Brolly, Kevin Clarke, Mary Mullan, Bert McGerty,
Jessie Gilloway, Tillie McLaughlin, Elizabeth Whitty, David Whitty,
Sally Turpin, Catherine McGonigle, Patsy Canning, Charlie Newland,
Vincent Magee, William McGill, Annu Matthews, Johnny McCullagh,
John Ward, Ann Mullan (McWilliams), Leo Kealey.

MONTH'S MIND MASSES:

The Month's Mind Mass for **Bridie Devine** will be celebrated
on **Saturday 19 September at 6.00pm** in **St. Finlough's Church**.



TRIDUUM OF MASSES FOR BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER: As the diocese
and parishes prepare to celebrate the joyous occasion of the Installation of
Bishop Michael Router as Bishop of Derry on **Sunday 20 September**, a
Triduum of Masses will be celebrated in parishes throughout the diocese, on
Friday 18, Saturday 19 and Sunday 20 September. In our parish, these
Masses will be celebrated:

on **Friday 18 September** in **Christ the King Church** at **10.00am**

on **Saturday 19 September** in **Christ the King Church** at **4.30pm** and
St. Finlough's Church at **6.00pm**

on **Sunday 20 September** in **Christ the King Church** at **9.00am** and **12 noon**
and in **St. Mary's Church** at **10.30am**.

All are welcome to attend as we come together as God's people to pray for
Bishop Router and the people of the diocese, that we may walk together in
faith and hope, guided by the Holy Spirit.



We welcome into God's family:

LUCAS HARKIN

CONNLA BRENDAN MCGONIGLE

WEEKLY COLLECTION:

£5,170

Thank you for your
continued generosity
and support.

IMPORTANT NOTICE

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION: Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese.

You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting on:

**Wed 30 Sept, 8.00pm,
in The Drummond Hotel, Ballykelly,
Registration and light refreshments from 7.30pm.**

WEEKLY EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

has resumed in **St. Mary's Church**
and takes place **each Thursday from 1.00pm to 6.00pm.**
**All are warmly welcome to come and spend some quiet time
in prayer before the Blessed Sacrament.**

FEAST OF ST VINCENT DE PAUL: Mass will be offered for all members of St. Vincent de Paul Society (past and present)

**at 9.00am on Sunday 27 September
in Christ the King Church.**

**ADULT CROCHET CLASS in ST. FINLOUGH'S HALL
resumes on MONDAY, 21 SEPTEMBER
at 7.30pm.**



New members welcome!



Could you Host for Hospice?

October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month! We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake!

**To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call
Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135
9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com**



LCDI VOLUNTEER DRIVERS AND VOLUNTEER ASSISTANTS

Meals on Wheels - Limavady Area

Help us deliver hot meals to the Limavady area.

Monday to Friday: 2 hours per week.

No experience needed, just a friendly face and a little time.

Telephone: Karen Cochrane (028) 703 65438.



QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY reopens for the new academic year on **Monday 14 September**, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on **20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!** New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at **qubcatholic.org** and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting – and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend!

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison

Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services

PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101

Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker)

Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459

Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

13 September 2026

Let It Go!

Peter thinks forgiving seven times is generous. Jesus says seventy-seven. Which means: stop counting!

Then Jesus tells a story about a servant who owed a fortune he could never repay. He begged, and the master wiped the whole thing out. Minutes later that same servant found a man who owed him a few months' wages and took him by the throat.

Look at him closely. He has just been handed the gift of a lifetime and he cannot see it. He is so buried in his own materialism, his own rights, his own small world, that the master's mercy has not touched him at all. He walked out of that room exactly the man he walked in. Forgiven, but not free.

That is the danger for every one of us. We can receive God's mercy again and again, in confession, at the altar, and still walk out clutching the old grudge. The neighbour. The sibling. The house. The land. The job promotion. The one who let us down. The First Reading puts it bluntly: resentment is a thing we nurse, and it eats the one holding it. It narrows our vision until, like that servant, we cannot see past the debt.

Jesus ends the parable with one condition: we must forgive from the heart. Not through gritted teeth. Not a cold truce that keeps the old score sheet handy in a drawer. Forgiveness is not pretending the wrong did not matter, but it is a real letting go, deep down from where the grudge lives. And the most powerful thing is that the moment we let it go, we are the one set free. The weight lifts. We can breathe.

So this week, as you receive mercy from God, go and be mercy in action. Name it. Let it go from the heart. Then you will enjoy the freedom God's love has won for us, now and forever.

Announcements

Triduum of Masses for Bishop Michael Router As the diocese and parishes prepare to celebrate the joyous occasion of the Installation of Bishop Michael Router as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20 September, a Triduum of Masses will be celebrated in parishes throughout the diocese, on Friday 18, Saturday 19 and Sunday 20 September. In our parishes, these Masses will be celebrated in St. Mary's Church at 10.00am on Friday 18 September; St. Theresa's Church at 10.00am on Saturday 19 September and St. Mary's Church at 11.30am on Sunday 20 September. All are welcome to attend as we come together as God's people to pray for Bishop Router and the people of the diocese, that we may walk together in faith and hope, guided by the Holy Spirit.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism

Siofra-Mai Ellen Patton

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Sr. Rose Ann Mulholland, St. Joseph's Convent of Mercy

Kathleen O'Hagan, Lifford

Albert O'Neill, 15 Sycamore Avenue

David Mullan, Omagh

Mickey McAleer, Woodmount Nursing Home

Anniversaries

Sonny Magee, Bridie Rouse, Mary Gormley

Donna Coulter, Hugh Gallagher, Bridget French

Agnes Walker, Tommy McGlinchey, Jimmy Coyle

Marcella Edginton, Eric Adams, Sarah McGettigan-Porter

Ellen Clarke, Clare McGonigle, Rebecca Coyle

Denis Sweeney, Patsy McElroy, Eileen McBride

Cissie Donaghey, Brian Semple, Willie Falconer

John Hegarty, Eugene Hegarty, Charlie Foley

Elizabeth Molloy, Daniel Molloy, Helen Callaghan

Noel McBride, Jim Patton

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3315.00; **Sion Mills:** £1135.00. Thank you.

Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 14 September after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Collection for Retired Priests The Annual Collection for Retired Priests will be taken up at all Masses today Sunday 13 September. This is a collection to help assist priests who have retired from active ministry. There is an envelope marked '*Clergy Retirement Fund*' in your box of envelopes for this collection. Anyone contributing to this collection by cheque should make it payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish.